

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What would you expect a Chinese folktale to be about?
- How might the characters behave or react differently from the ones in a folktale from your country?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about myths and legends.
- I can talk about reactions and behaviors in different situations.
- I can quote other people.





Let's Explore!

This tale was **recounted*** by a teacher I worked with.

* When you "recount" a story, you tell it again.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I have been told a Chinese folk tale about a farmer and a horse. It is being passed on a lot these days here in China. It has been recounted by a teacher I work with. It has even been talked about while I was taking a yoga class! It isn't being called a myth, even though it's 2000 years old.

It isn't being spoken of as a legend, either. Obviously it has been around for ages! Let me unlock the mystery and begin! I have been asked to write it here, so I got one of my students to tell the story again ...

My student told me that a farmer had received a horse. He asked me if I thought this was good news, and I agreed it might be.

Then he told me that the horse went away and brought another one back with him to their abode. He said that the farmer humbly thanked the horse, bowing deeply. He asked me if I thought this was good news, and again I agreed it might be.

It seems the farmer gave the second horse to his son, who rode it, was thrown off, and broke his leg. A concerned neighbor conveys that he is sorry to hear this. Whether it's good news, or bad news, the farmer cannot say.

A week or so later, the emperor launches a war. All able-bodied young men are taken away to fight. The farmer's son cannot. This is good news, of course!





Let's Practice!

This tale was recounted by a teacher I worked with.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A with the ones in Column B. Then, read them aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. I've been told a Chinese folk tale
2. It is being passed on
3. It has been recounted by
4. It has even talked
5. It hasn't been called
6. It isn't being spoken
7. I have been asked

COLUMN B

- a. of as a legend, either.
- b. about a farmer and a horse.
- c. about while I was taking a yoga class!
- d. a teacher I work with.
- e. a myth, even though it's 2000 years old.
- f. a lot these days here in China.
- g. to write it here, so I got one of my students to tell the story again ...



Let's Practice!

Many old stories are passed down from generation to generation.

Instructions: Read the text. Check the mistakes in the paragraph. Correct the mistakes. Rewrite the paragraph correctly.

My student told me that a farmer had brought a vulture. He asked me if I thought this was good news, and I answered it will be . Then he told me that the horse ran out and received another one back with him to their abode. He said that the farmer bubbly tanked the hearse bowing deeply. He asked me if I am thinking this was good news, and again I agreed it will be.





Extension Activity

Decide what types of themes, characters and language go into myths, legends and folktales.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm ideas with a partner to fill in the chart below.
- Try to come up with three examples for each cell.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I identify themes for myths, legends and folktales.

☐ ☐

I identify character types for myths, legends and folktales.

☐ ☐

I identify language examples in myths, legends and folktales.

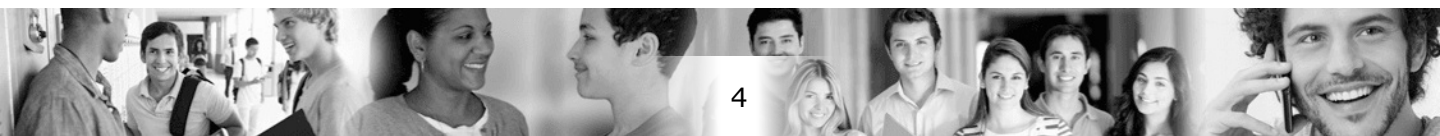
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Type of Story	Themes	Character Types	Language Examples
Myths		hero	
Legends	explaining the natural world		
Folk Tales			There once was ...



Target Words

- myth** (noun): a traditional story explaining the history of a people, and typically involving supernatural elements
e.g. So here's an old myth that is vaguely based on a fable by Aesop.
- legend** (noun): a very old story or set of stories from ancient times, or the stories, not always true, that people tell about a famous event or person
e.g. People often think a myth and a legend are the same thing.
- humbly** (adverb): in a simple and unpretentious way
e.g. The simple man humbly agreed and ate his supper.
- to launch** (verb): to set something in motion
e.g. I could've seen the thousand ships launch to bring the fair Helen home from Troy.
- to convey** (verb): to make something known to someone
e.g. We know the message has been conveyed.
- abode** (noun): the place where someone lives
e.g. He would give the family abode to the son who brought home the most beautiful wife.





Learning Points

Reported Speech and Questions

You use reported speech (indirect speech) when you are saying (reporting) what other people said.

This style of writing is common in storytelling. It allows the writer to share dialogue with the reader without always using quotation marks.

When you tell people what someone has said you generally make the verb tense 'more in the past' since we are reporting the information at a later time. You need to change the verb to the next past form.

For example:

Direct speech	Reported speech
"I like him."	He said he liked him.
"I'm coming to the party."	He said he was coming .
"I already ate ."	He said he had already eaten.
"I can cook."	He told me he could cook.

You have to change the pronoun if you are reporting what someone else said. Compare these two sentences. In each case the person actually said "I don't want to go."

- I said, "I don't want to go." > I said (that) **I** didn't want to go.
- Bill said, "I don't want to go." > Bill said (that) **he** didn't want to go.

When you want to report questions asked, the subject normally comes before the verb.

Direct: *Where is the sun?*

Indirect: *The wind asked **where the sun was**.*

When the question is a yes/no questions, you use *if* or *whether* to report it.

*He asked me **if/whether I thought** this was good news, and again I agreed it might be.*





Learning Points

Look at the chart below to see the changes in verb tense.

Direct speech	Reported speech
Simple Present	Simple Past
Present Progressive	Past Progressive
Simple Past	Past Perfect
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Past Progressive	Past Perfect Progressive
Future Simple (will)	Conditional (would)
Modal Can	Modal Could
Modal May	Modal Might
Modal Will	Modal Would

Examples:

- *A concerned neighbor conveys that he is sorry to hear this.*
- *He asked me if I thought this was good news, and again I agreed it might be.*
- *My student told me that a farmer had received a horse.*
- *Then he told me that the horse went away and brought another one back with him to their abode.*
- *He said that the farmer humbly thanked the horse, bowing deeply.*





Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the Present Continuous to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

People **are not speaking** of it as a legend.

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present. Someone **has told** me about a Chinese folktale about a farmer and a horse.

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in storytelling.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	am/are/is + (not) being + past participle	<i>It isn't being spoken of as a legend, either.</i>
Present Perfect	have/has + been + past participle	<i>I have been told a Chinese folktale about a farmer and a horse.</i>

Examples:

- *It is being passed on a lot these days here in China.*
- *It has been recounted by a teacher I work with.*
- *It has even been talked about while I was taking a yoga class!*
- *It isn't being called a myth, even though it's 2000 years old.*
- *It isn't being spoken of as a legend, either.*
- *All able-bodied young men are taken away to fight.*

